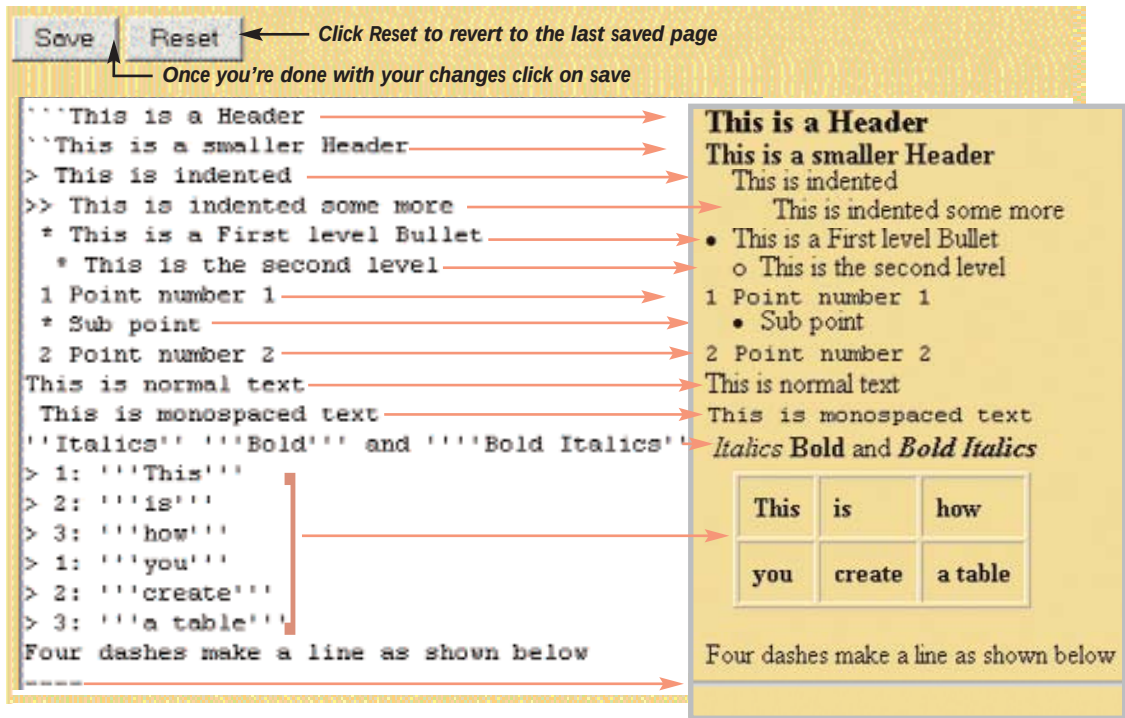




To help you understand how most Wiki's work, above we've shown the text box that you get when you click on the EditPage link, or 'Edit the text of this page' link on a Wiki page. On the right we've shown how the page is displayed once you click save. Look closely and you'll understand exactly what Wiki syntax is. It's easy really, just use a Wiki's SandBox page to experiment

UsingWiki

Wiki integrates with a Web server to serve pages, as well as allow users to create and modify pages. These servers work in three different modes: The first, allows anyone to edit pages; the second, only allows authors selected by the site administrator to edit a page, but every-

one can view the pages; the third allows everyone to see the Wiki, but only a few of its pages can be modified by selected authors. Needless to say, Wikizens believe that these protected Wikis just aren't Wiki anymore. Most Wikis have a few things in common though:

The StartPage: The first page states the philosophy of that particular Wiki, and has links to other important pages such as the RecentChanges and WikiFormatting pages. It is also called Front Page on some Wikis.

The WikiFormatting page: Also known as the HowTo page, WikiSyntax page, etc. These are tutorials on using the Wiki syntax while editing or adding a page. Make sure you go through this page at every Wiki you visit, or else you're likely to commit a few bloopers. Though most Wikis use the general formatting discussed in this article, there are some with minor differences.

The RecentChanges page: This is generated by the server and cannot be edited. It keeps everyone posted about who changed what, and when. The Wikizens of a par-

ticular Wiki will often be on the lookout here for 'impolite' behaviour.

The EditPage link: Also called EditText, EditTextOfThisPage, etc. When you click on it, you are shown a box containing all the text of that page—with the formatting (single quotes, tabs, etc.)—all you have to do is add or delete text, add the style of formatting you want, and click Save.

The FindPages or Search link: This takes you to a search page where you can search by page, or by content.

That's about all you need to see on a

Wiki. After seeing these pages, if you want to create a new page, edit an existing page, add a link to your page, etc.; go ahead and do just that!



The RecentChanges page is how Wiki owners keep track of all the changes that people make. Every time a page is modified, it is listed on the RecentChanges page.

WikiFarms

So you want to start your own Wiki, but have no place to host it... don't worry, the thoughtful Wiki community has even that covered. There are places called Wiki farms that encourage and nurture all that is Wiki. Some are free and others charge standard Web hosting charges.

Two free Wiki farms are SeedWiki (www.seedwiki.com) and Swiki (www.swiki.net). Both use formatting that is different from classic Wiki, but all your pages can be edited by anyone

SeedWiki uses the WYSIWYG method of editing, which gives you the option of editing a page using ActiveEdit control (MS Word style interface), a Java Applet, an HTML Editor, or plain text. However, you need a paid account to be able to upload documents and images.

Swiki needs you to sign up for an account, after which you can start creating your Wiki. you can upload documents and images, and get 25 MB of space for them.